

PROJECT DOCUMENTATION

Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow

Technical Project Documentation
College Project Portfolio
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Prepared from the supplied ServiceNow project material and screenshot evidence index

Table of Contents

1. 1. Project Overview
2. 2. Problem Statement and Objectives
3. 3. Functional Scope
4. 4. Stakeholders and User Roles
5. 5. Solution Design and Lifecycle
6. 6. Service Configuration
7. 7. Service Offering Configuration
8. 8. Incident Creation and Classification
9. 9. Knowledge / Agent Assist Integration
10. 10. Assignment and Escalation
11. 11. SLA Tracking
12. 12. Configuration Item Update
13. 13. Incident On Hold and Change Dependency
14. 14. Child Incident Management
15. 15. Cause and Resolution
16. 16. Knowledge Creation
17. 17. Final Validation
18. 18. Expected Results
19. 19. Limitations and Evidence Notes
20. 20. Conclusion

1. Project Overview

Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow is designed to standardize the complete IT Incident Management lifecycle, from incident creation and classification through knowledge assistance, escalation, investigation, resolution, related-record management, and SLA tracking.

The implemented scenario focuses on a Corporate VPN connectivity incident. The project demonstrates how ServiceNow can provide structured ownership, classification, contextual knowledge, support escalation, child-incident relationships, resolution documentation, and visibility through related records and SLAs.

Implemented lifecycle

Incident Creation → Classification → Knowledge Search → Assignment/Escalation → Investigation → Change if Required → Resolution → Knowledge Creation → SLA Validation

2. Problem Statement and Objectives

Problem Statement

The project identifies common challenges in informal IT support processes, including poor tracking, inconsistent classification, delayed escalation, limited visibility into resolution progress, SLA risk, and difficulty reusing successful fixes.

Business Objectives

- Enable Service Desk agents to create and classify incidents consistently.
- Use Knowledge Management and Agent Assist to support faster troubleshooting.
- Allow reassignment to appropriate support teams and Level 2 technicians.
- Support emergency-change workflow when infrastructure changes are required.
- Allow child incidents to be linked to a parent incident.
- Capture cause and resolution information for future reuse.
- Create or attach Knowledge articles from resolved work.
- Improve SLA compliance and service visibility.

3. Functional Scope

- Incident record creation in Service Operations Workspace.
- Incident classification using Category, Subcategory, Urgency, Service, Service Offering, and Configuration Item.
- Agent Assist Knowledge integration.
- Reassignment and Level 2 escalation.
- Emergency Change integration as an intended workflow.
- Child Incident creation and relationship management.
- Cause and resolution documentation.
- Knowledge article creation and attachment.
- SLA and Related Records tracking.

4. Stakeholders and User Roles

Stakeholder	Role / Need	Expectation	Automation Impact
End Users	Report IT issues	Quick resolution and visibility	Faster resolution and transparent tracking
Service Desk Agents	First-level support	Easy logging and classification	Standardized intake and faster escalation
Level 2 Support	Diagnose and resolve	Complete incident data	Better diagnosis and clear ownership
Change Management Team	Handle emergency changes	Structured change requests	Integrated change control
ServiceNow Admin	Maintain configuration	Scalable, trackable solution	Centralized configuration and monitoring
Incident Manager	Monitor lifecycle	SLA and escalation visibility	Better SLA compliance and process control
Knowledge Manager	Manage knowledge	Accurate reusable solutions	Faster knowledge creation

Primary roles demonstrated

- End User / Caller
- Service Desk Agent
- Level 2 Support Technician
- Incident Manager
- Knowledge / Change Management roles

5. Solution Design and Lifecycle

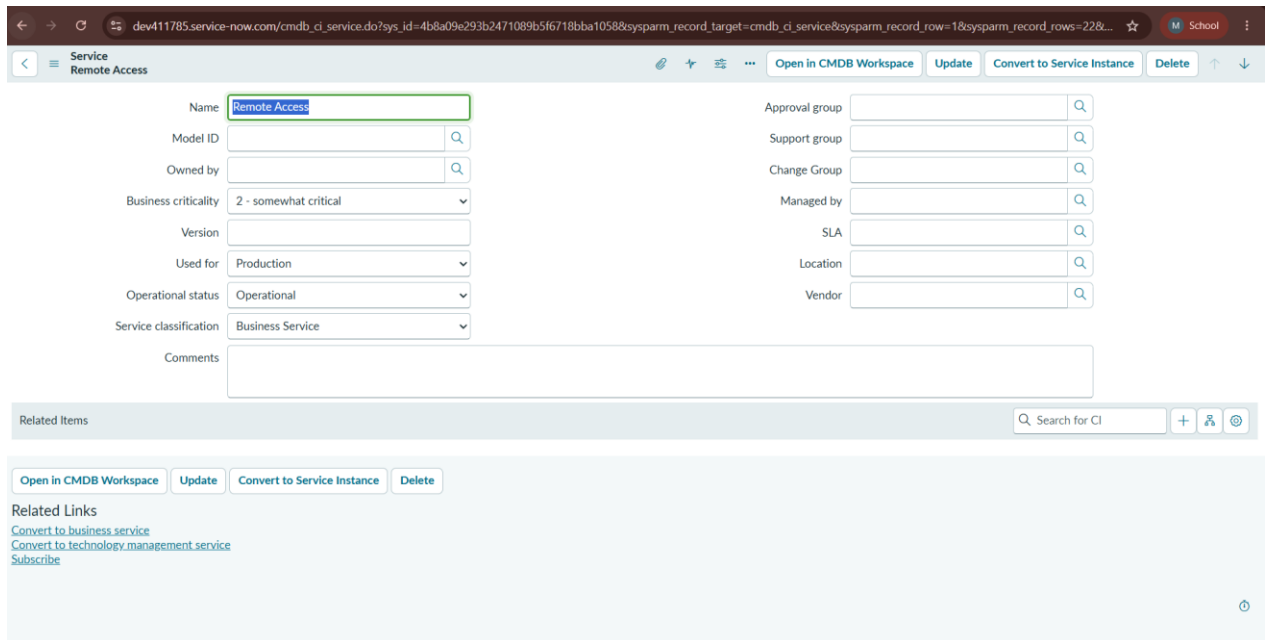
The solution is organized around a controlled incident lifecycle. Each stage adds information or control needed for the next stage, creating a traceable record from intake to resolution.

Stage	Main Activity	Expected Outcome
1	Incident Creation	A formal incident record is created.
2	Classification	The incident is categorized and associated with the relevant service.
3	Knowledge Search	Relevant Knowledge articles are surfaced through Agent Assist.
4	Assignment / Escalation	Ownership moves to the appropriate support level.
5	Investigation	Technician investigates the reported issue.

6	Change if Required	A change dependency can be handled through the intended change workflow.
7	Resolution	Cause and resolution notes are recorded.
8	Knowledge Creation	A reusable article can be created or attached.
9	SLA Validation	SLA and related records are checked.

6. Service Configuration

The implemented service foundation uses Remote Access as the top-level service for remote connectivity support. Its operational status is recorded as Operational.



The screenshot displays the 'Service Remote Access' configuration page in ServiceNow. The page includes a header with navigation links and a toolbar with buttons for 'Open in CMDB Workspace', 'Update', 'Convert to Service Instance', and 'Delete'. The main form contains the following fields:

- Name: Remote Access
- Model ID: [Search]
- Owned by: [Search]
- Business criticality: 2 - somewhat critical
- Version: [Search]
- Used for: Production
- Operational status: Operational
- Service classification: Business Service
- Approval group: [Search]
- Support group: [Search]
- Change Group: [Search]
- Managed by: [Search]
- SLA: [Search]
- Location: [Search]
- Vendor: [Search]
- Comments: [Text Area]

Below the form, there is a 'Related Items' section with a search bar and a 'Related Links' section with links to 'Convert to business service', 'Convert to technology management service', and 'Subscribe'.

Figure 1: Remote Access service configuration in ServiceNow.

Expected evidence: Name = Remote Access; Operational status = Operational.

7. Service Offering Configuration

Corporate VPN is configured as a Service Offering under the Remote Access service. This provides a more specific service context for VPN-related incidents.

The screenshot displays the ServiceNow interface for configuring a 'Corporate VPN' service offering. The page is titled 'Offering - Corporate VPN' and includes a search bar and navigation links. The configuration fields are organized into two columns. The left column contains fields for Name, Model ID, Owned by, Parent (set to Remote Access), Used for (Production), Operational status (Operational), Vendor, Short Description, Description, Comments, and Contract. The right column contains fields for Approval group, Support group, Change group, Managed by, Version, Business criticality (2 - somewhat critical), SLA, and Location. The 'Parent' field is highlighted with a green border.

Figure 2: Corporate VPN service offering configured under Remote Access.

Expected evidence: Name = Corporate VPN; Parent = Remote Access; Operational status = Operational.

8. Incident Creation and Classification

Incident scenario

Short Description: Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office

Caller: Michael Hoefer

Assignment Group: Service Desk

Classification details

Field	Implemented Value
Channel	Phone
Category	Network
Subcategory	VPN
Urgency	2 - Medium
Service	Remote Access
Service Offering	Corporate VPN
Configuration Item	Initially ThinkStationS20; later updated to PowerEdge

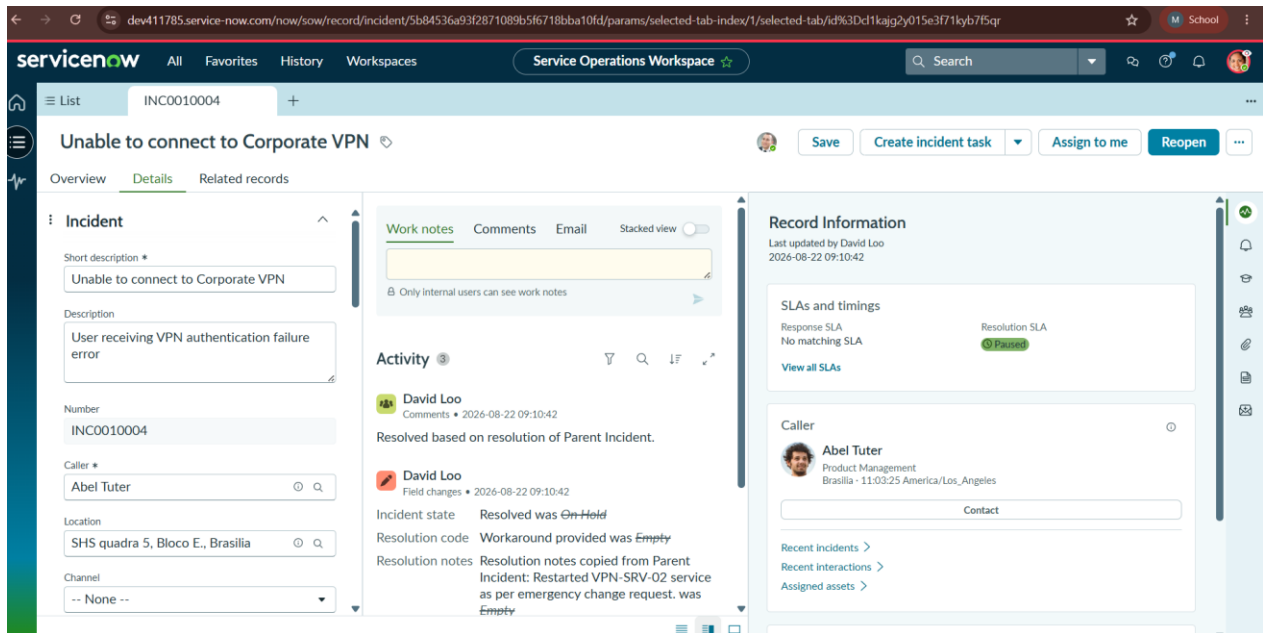


Figure 3: Incident classification and service configuration.

Expected evidence: incident details and classification fields shown in Service Operations Workspace.

9. Knowledge / Agent Assist Integration

Agent Assist is used to surface Knowledge articles relevant to the incident short description. The demonstrated workflow includes opening Knowledge Articles, reviewing a relevant article, marking it Helpful, and attaching the article to the incident.

The documented comment used with the article was:

“Follow the Steps and Resolve the Incident.”

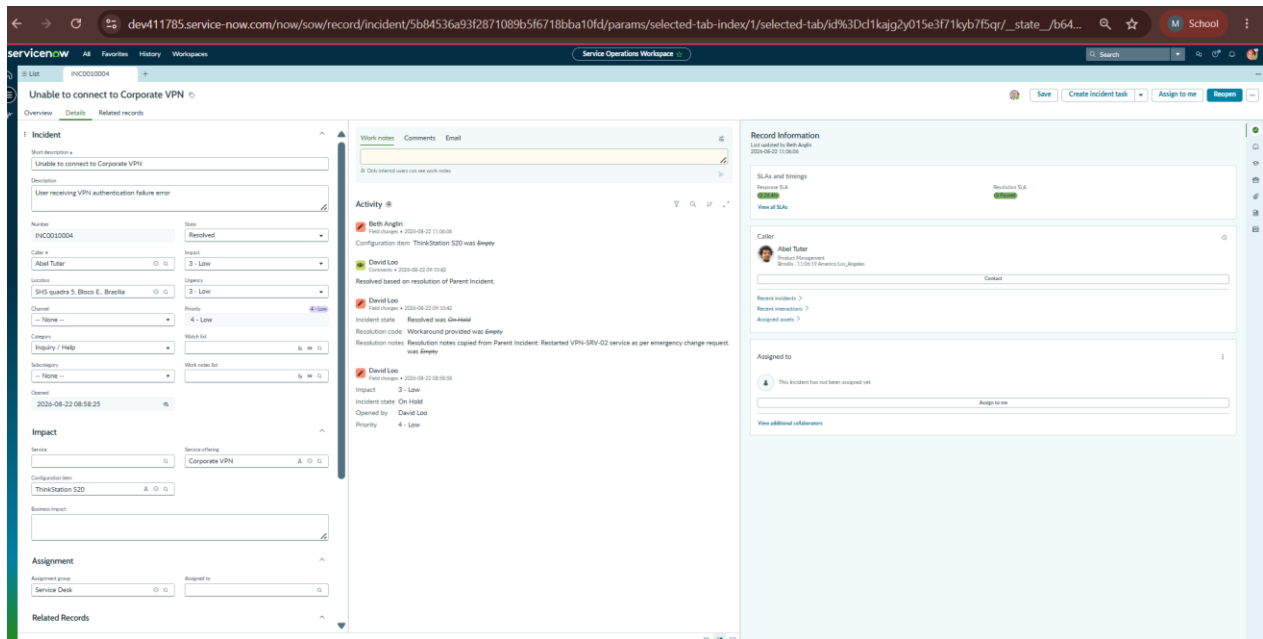


Figure 4: Agent Assist displaying relevant Knowledge articles.

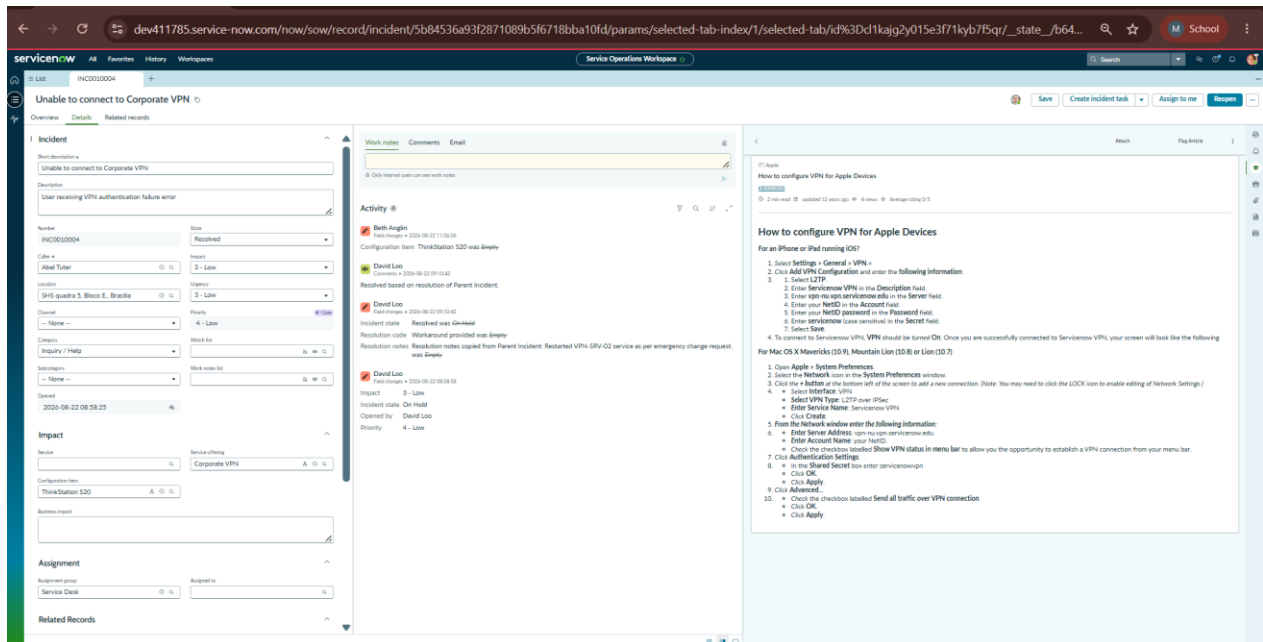


Figure 5: Knowledge article attached to the incident.

Use the supplied evidence showing the article attached or relevant activity.

10. Assignment and Escalation

When first-level support cannot complete the investigation, the incident can be reassigned to Level 2. In the implemented scenario, the incident was accessed while impersonating David Loo and the incident was assigned to the appropriate technician using Assign to me.

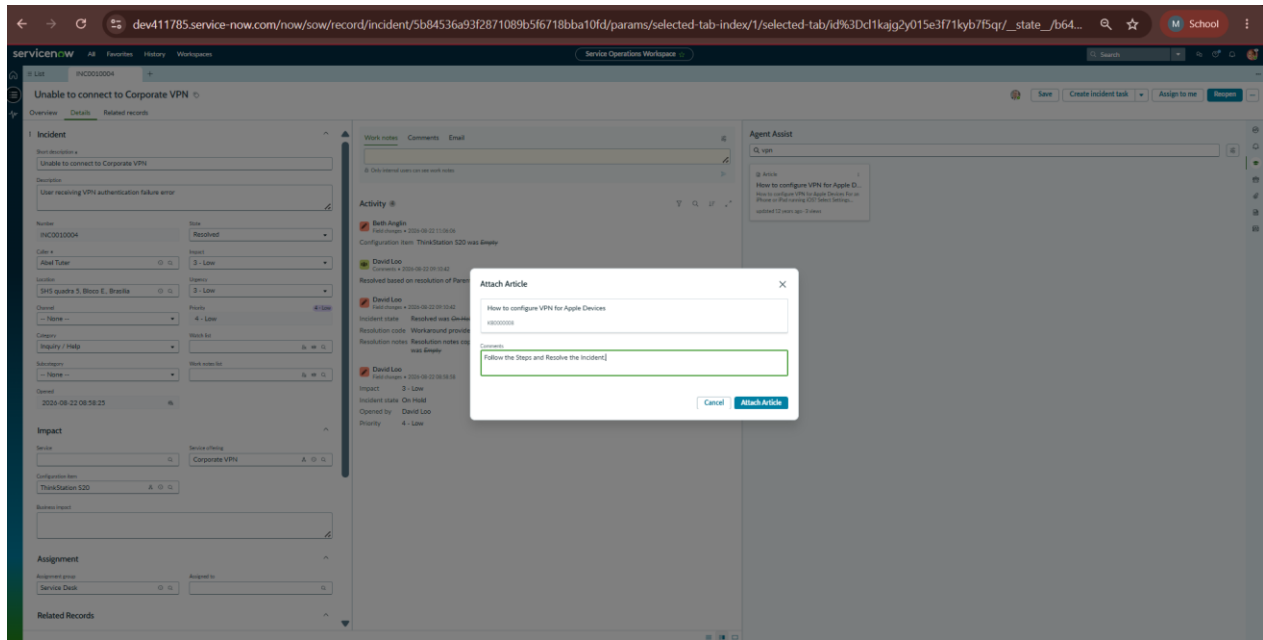


Figure 6: Incident assigned to Level 2 support.

Expected evidence: assignment / ownership information for the Level 2 technician.

11. SLA Tracking

Related Records displayed Task SLAs (4). The records included response and resolution SLA information, with visible stages and breach tracking. This provides operational visibility into incident response and resolution performance.

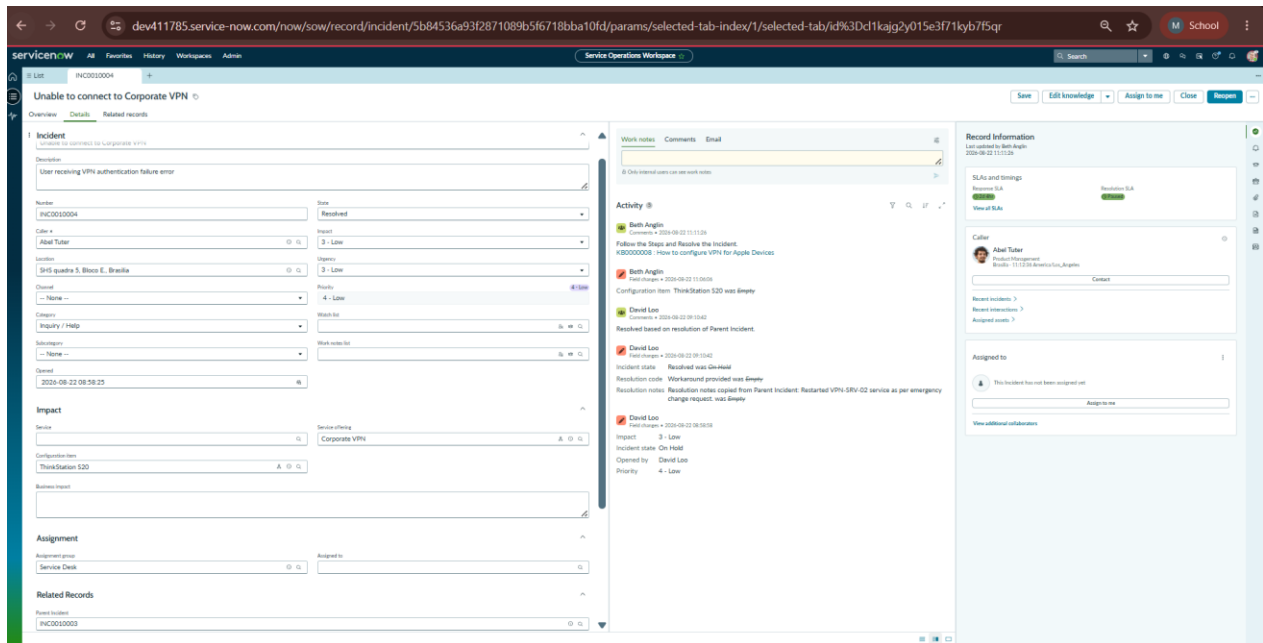


Figure 7: SLA records displayed under Task SLAs.

Expected evidence: Task SLAs (4), including response and resolution SLA records.

12. Configuration Item Update

The Configuration Item was initially recorded as ThinkStationS20 and was later changed to PowerEdge as the investigation progressed.

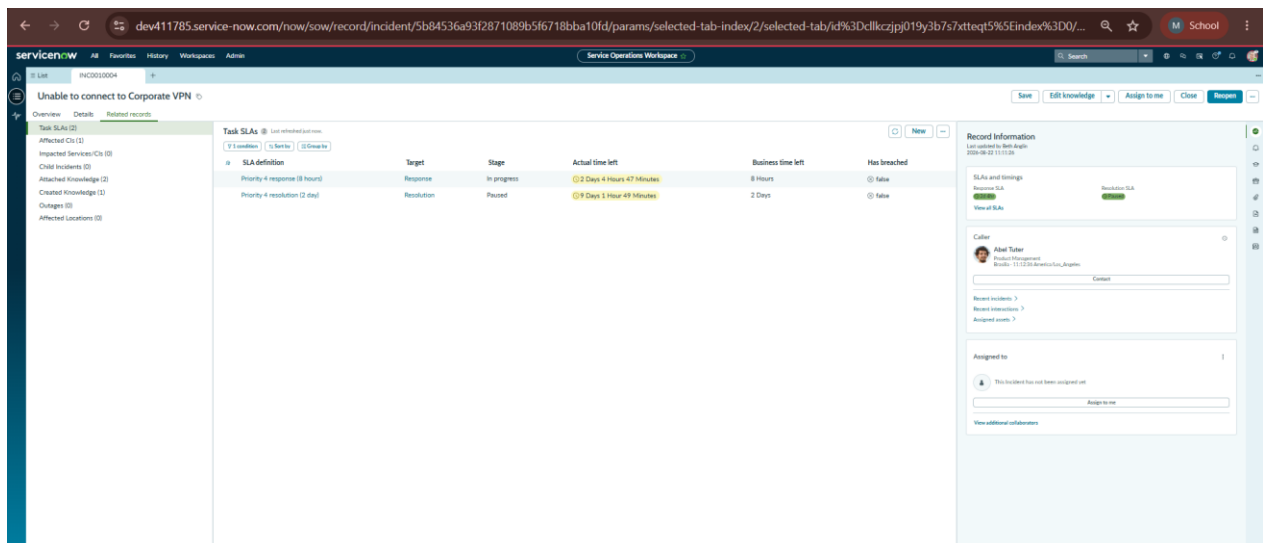


Figure 8: Configuration Item updated to PowerEdge.

Expected evidence: Configuration Item = PowerEdge.

13. Incident On Hold and Change Dependency

When a permanent fix depends on an infrastructure change, the incident is placed On Hold with the reason Awaiting Change. This state provides visibility that the incident is waiting for another activity before final resolution.

State: On Hold

On Hold Reason: Awaiting Change

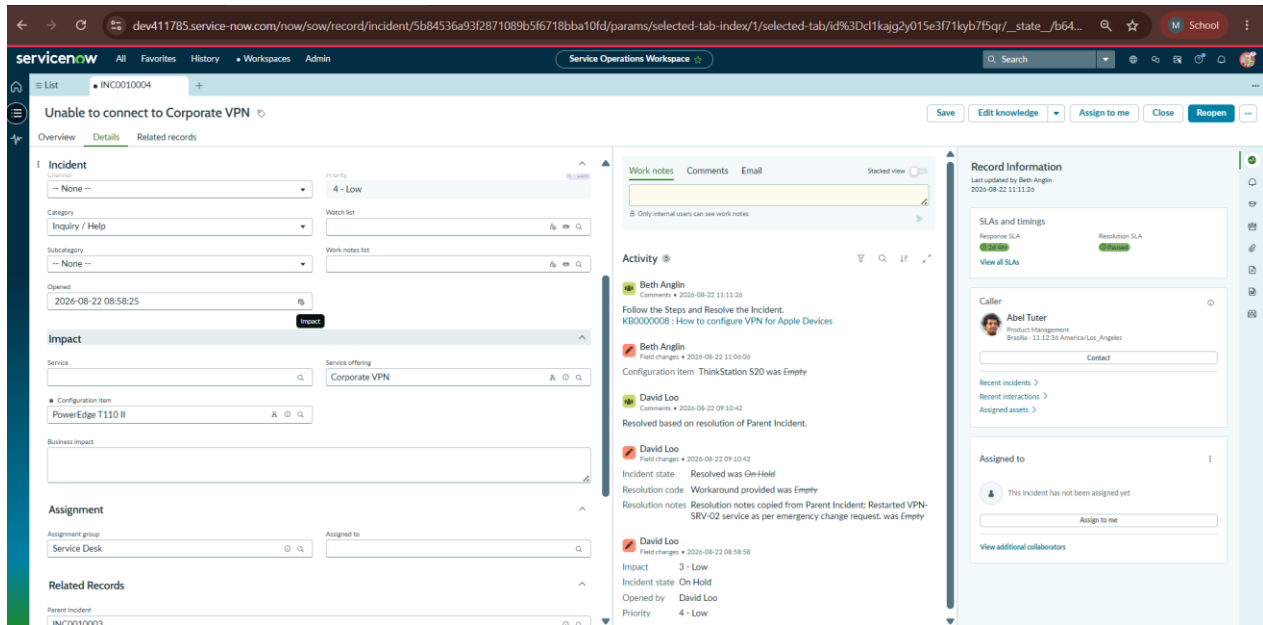


Figure 9: Incident placed On Hold awaiting change.

Expected evidence: State = On Hold; On Hold Reason = Awaiting Change.

14. Child Incident Management

A Child Incident was created from Related Records → Child Incidents → New. The child incident was linked to the parent incident so that related reports can be managed together.

Child incident details:

- Short Description: Unable to connect to Corporate VPN
- Caller: Any selected user
- Description: User receiving VPN authentication failure error.
- The child incident was linked to the parent incident.

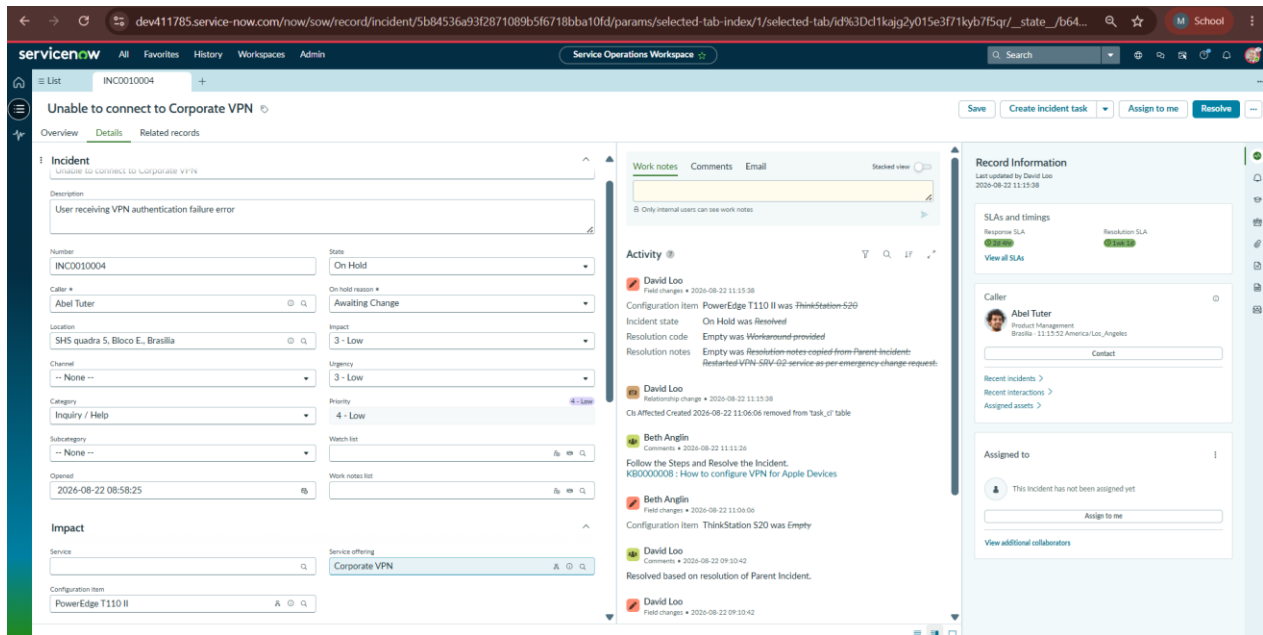


Figure 10: Child incident linked to the parent incident.

Expected evidence: Related Records → Child Incidents and the linked child record.

15. Cause and Resolution

The implemented scenario documents the following probable cause:

Probable Cause: PowerEdge service was suspended and required restart.

Resolution Code: Workaround provided

Resolution Notes: Restarted VPN-SRV-02 service as per emergency change request. The incident was then resolved.

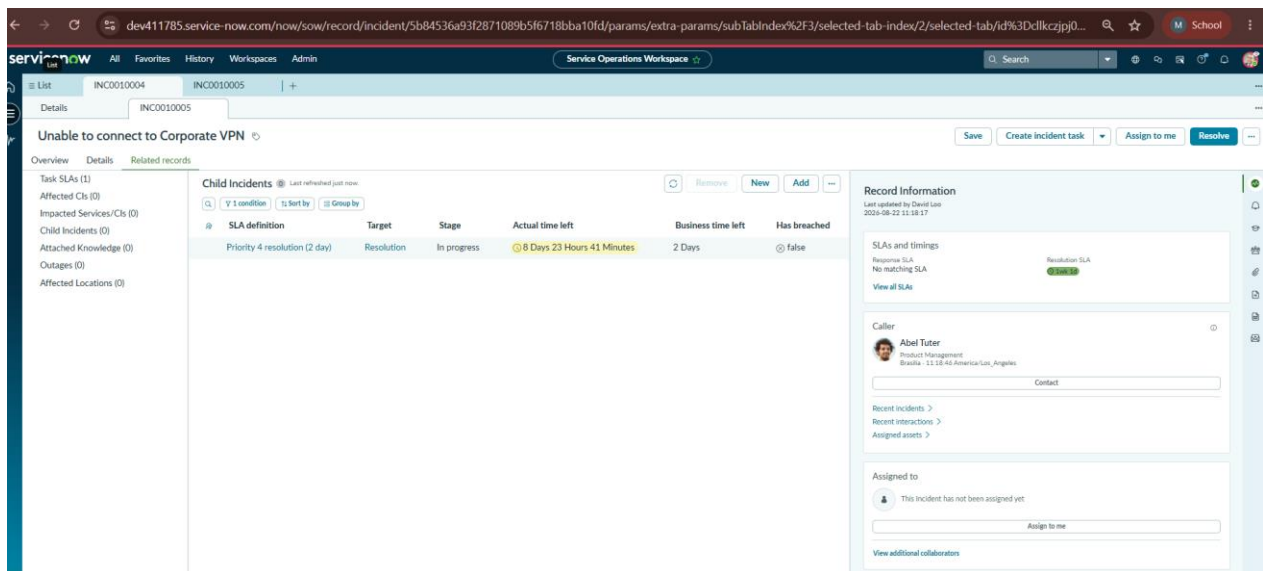


Figure 11: Incident cause and resolution documented.

16. Knowledge Creation

After resolution, the project workflow includes creating reusable Knowledge from the incident. The documented path is Create Knowledge → Knowledge Base: IT → Article Template: Standard → Next → Verify Details → Save. The parent incident's Related Records showed Attached Knowledge (1).

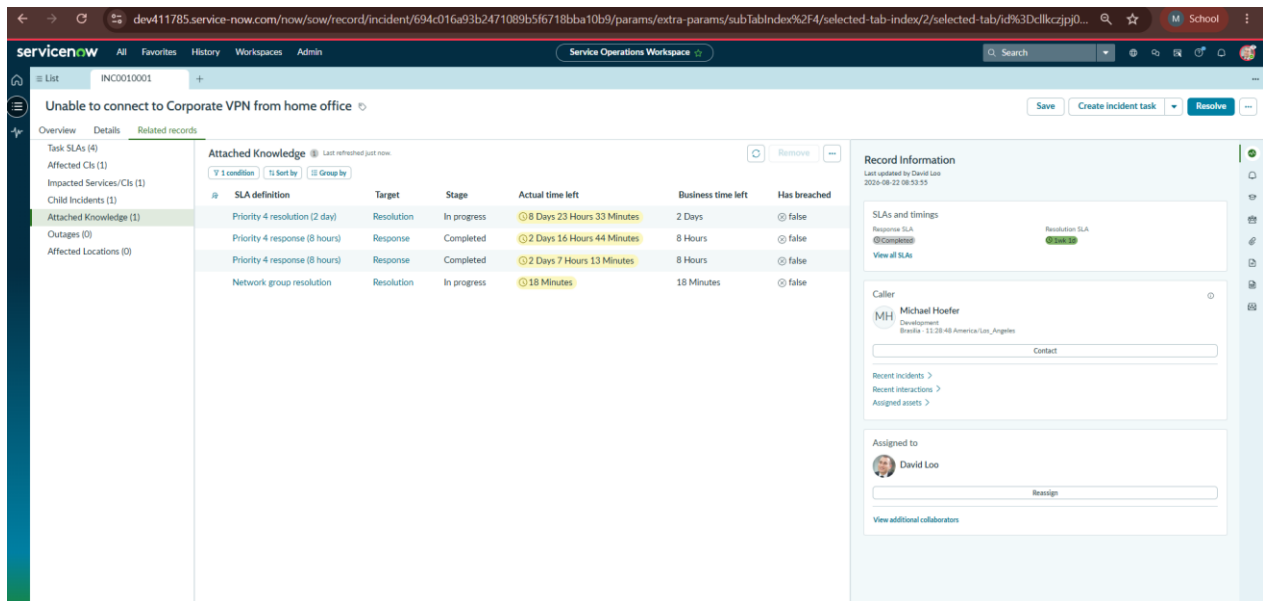


Figure 12: Knowledge article associated with the resolved incident.

Expected evidence: Attached Knowledge (1) or the created Knowledge article.

17. Final Validation

The final validation checks the completed lifecycle and confirms that the major incident relationships and resolution information are present.

- Parent incident = Resolved.
- Child incident is present and resolved.
- Resolution activity is recorded.
- Knowledge is created or attached.
- SLA tracking is visible.
- Related records support the documented lifecycle.
- Multi-team collaboration is represented through assignment and related records.

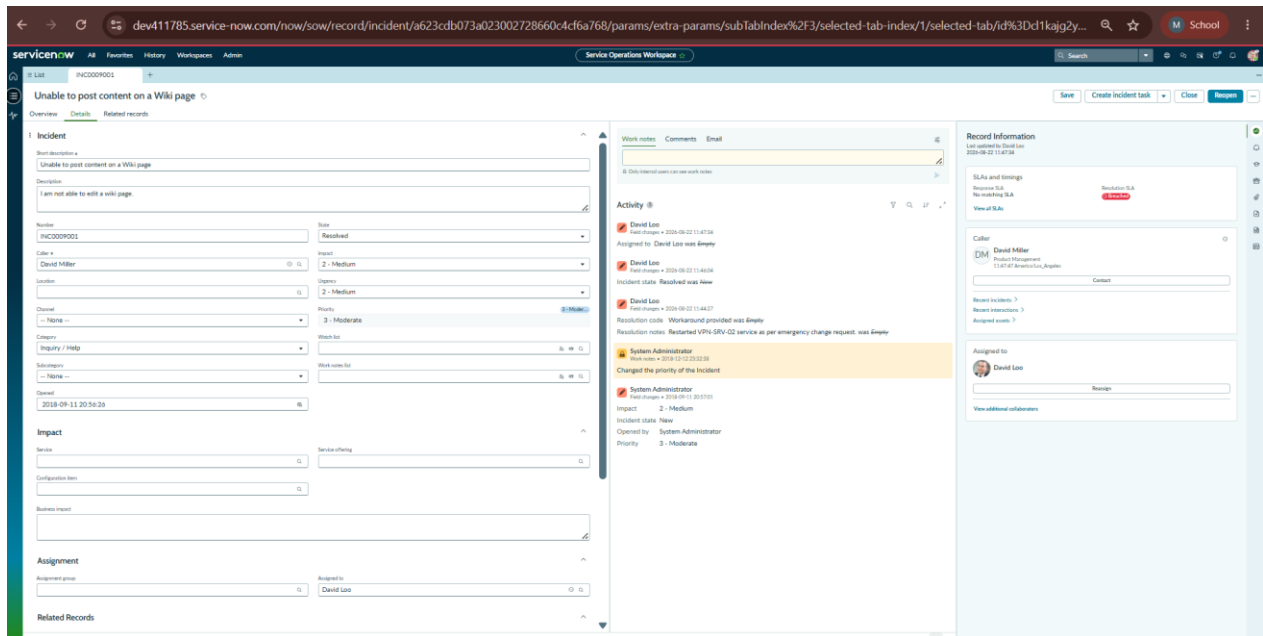


Figure 13: Final incident lifecycle validation.

Expected evidence: Parent = Resolved, Child Incident, Attached Knowledge, Task SLAs, and activity / related records.

18. Expected Results

- Structured and consistent incident intake.
- Improved classification and service visibility.
- Faster troubleshooting through contextual Knowledge.
- Clear ownership and Level 2 escalation.
- Visibility into SLA response and resolution tracking.
- Support for related issues through Child Incidents.
- Documented cause and resolution history.
- Reusable Knowledge captured from resolved work.
- Improved collaboration across Incident, Knowledge, and Change processes.

19. Limitations and Evidence Notes

Important evidence limitation: The Change Request verification screenshot for Step 13 was skipped in the supplied project material. This documentation therefore does not claim that a Change Request screenshot was captured. The Change integration is described only as part of the intended/project workflow and the documented incident resolution notes.

All supplied screenshots have been embedded in the corresponding figure locations throughout this final document. Figure numbering follows the supplied placement guide.

20. Conclusion

The Incident Lifecycle Automation project demonstrates a structured ServiceNow approach to IT Incident Management. The implemented scenario covers service and service-offering configuration, incident creation and classification, Agent Assist Knowledge integration, Level 2 escalation, SLA tracking, Configuration Item updates, On Hold handling, Child Incidents, cause and resolution documentation, Knowledge creation, and final lifecycle validation.

The resulting workflow provides a traceable and reusable method for handling VPN-related incidents while improving ownership, visibility, collaboration, and knowledge reuse.

Appendix A — Screenshot Evidence Index

Figure	Embedded screenshot evidence
Figure 1	Remote Access service configuration
Figure 2	Corporate VPN service offering
Figure 3	Incident classification
Figure 4	Agent Assist / Knowledge search
Figure 5	Knowledge article attached
Figure 6	Level 2 assignment
Figure 7	Task SLAs (4)
Figure 8	Configuration Item = PowerEdge
Figure 9	On Hold / Awaiting Change
Figure 10	Child Incident
Figure 11	Cause and resolution
Figure 12	Attached Knowledge / Knowledge creation
Figure 13	Final validation

End of Project Documentation